against England at Lord's and our pre-tour hopes of becoming the first South African team since readmission to win a Test series in England appear to be forlorn.

We all know the history. Kepler Wessels' touring squad drew the series 1–1 in 1994, Hansie Cronjé's side lost 2–1 in 1998, and Graeme's team drew 2–2 in 2003. We all believe we have the ability to set the record straight, but we have not started well and the captain is clearly agitated as he addresses his players.

'We can't give our wickets away so cheaply,' he says. 'AB, that wasn't good enough.'

What?

Did he say my name? Is he blaming me?

Doesn't he understand how I play? If somebody like Monty Panesar is going to bowl at me with a slip, I'm going to take him on and hit him straight back over his head. That's how I play. If Graeme doesn't understand that by now, then he really doesn't understand me. I am disappointed. Is he really blaming me?

Maybe Graeme is still annoyed because he won the toss and sent England in to bat, and they proceeded to score 593 for eight, with Ian Bell and Kevin Pietersen both scoring big hundreds. To be fair, it seemed a reasonable decision at the time, with something in the wicket but, for once, our bowlers misfired.

We know we need to bat well on the third day – the celebrated Saturday of the Lord's Test, one of the highlights of the English summer – but we are poor, losing wickets regularly and giving the capacity home crowd so much more to enjoy than just their chilled champagne and their salmon sandwiches.

When Neil McKenzie is bowled by Panesar in the second over after lunch, we are struggling at 83 for four and Ashwell Prince and I come together and set about the task of rebuilding the innings. Panesar and Stuart Broad are on a roll and I am simply trying to survive, scoring four